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Carcassonne

The city of Carcassonne in southern France (– pronounced: »Car-ca-sonn«) is famous for its unique walls and castles dating back to Roman and medieval times. You and your followers are traveling through Carcassonne, along its roads and across its fields, visiting its cities and monasteries in search of your fortune. The development of this ever-changing landscape is in your hands. Cleverly place your followers as travelers, knights, monks and farmers to pave your way to victory!

THE BASE GAME — *35 Min*

COMPONENTS & SETUP

Welcome to ***Carcassonne***! After reading the short rules for the base game (pages 3-7), you can already introduce and teach the game to other players. Before you start playing, you just need to set up the game.
Here is an overview of the game materials and how to prepare them for the game:

72 Land tiles
The square **land tiles** depict green **fields** with **roads**, **cities** and **monasteries**.


Tile with a city segment


Tile with a road segment


Tile with a monastery

You can recognize the land tiles from the **base game** by the fact that **none** of the watermarks and **no river** are on them (see page 22 for the full list).
The **backs** of these 72 land tiles are identical, only the **starting tile** has a **dark back**.

8 Score tiles
Set the 50/100 score tiles aside. These will help you keep track of your points later in the game.



Front side



Back side


Normal back


Dark back



To set up the game, place the **starting tile** (dark back) in the middle of the table. This is the start of the **play area**. Shuffle the remaining land tiles and place them face down in several stacks on the table so that everyone can access them easily.


Starting tile


Several face-down tile stacks

Place the **scoreboard** near the play area.


Standard meeple

48 Meeple

The so-called **meeple** ('meeple' is a combination of **'my people'**, which is both singular and plural) represent your followers in the game. Some expansions include additional meeple types. In the base game, you only need the 48 **standard meeple**. There are 6 sets of 8 standard meeple each in the colours **Black** , **Red** , **Green** , **Pink** , **Blue** and **Yellow** .
Give each player their **own supply** of 7 meeple in their chosen colour. Place the 8th meeple of each colour on **space 0** of the scoreboard. This is your **score meeple** that marks your score.
Return all the meeple of the colours that are not playing to the box.
Then you are done with the setup.

OBJECT OF THE GAME

Turn by turn, you will add land tiles to the play area. This will gradually create a landscape with different features such as monasteries, roads, cities and fields. You can deploy your meeple as monks, travelers, knights and (later on) farmers. They can score you points during the game but also at the end. For who has the most points and therefore wins the game is only decided in the final scoring!

GAMEPLAY

Players take turns in clockwise turn order. The youngest player starts. In your turn you must resolve the following **3 actions** in the **indicated order**. Then it's the next player's turn and so on. First, we list the actions and then explain them as if it were your turn. After reading the rules, you can explain them to the other players in exactly the same way. The 3 actions are:

1. Place a land tile
You **must** draw **exactly 1 land tile** from the face-down tile stacks and **place** it in such a way that it **matches** the land tiles in the play area.



2. Place a meeple
You **may** place **1 meeple** from **your supply** on the tile you just placed.



3. Score points
You **must** resolve **all scorings** triggered by placing your tile.



Now we will look in detail at what the features (roads, cities and monasteries) on the land tiles mean. We will explain them to you as if you had drawn a tile with the respective feature in your turn. Let's start with the roads:

The Roads

1. Place a land tile

The tile you have drawn shows 3 roads starting from a village. You must place it in the play area adjacent to **matching** land tiles. This means that an open road must be continued by another road, a field by a field or a city by a city.
You place your tile so that it continues the road and the field.

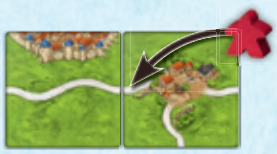


You place this tile. The road matches the road and the field matches the field.

In the rare case that you **cannot** place a matching tile **anywhere**, return the tile to the box and draw a new one.

2. Place a meeple

After placing the tile, you **may** place 1 standard meeple from your supply as a **traveler** on a **road on this tile**. However, this is only possible if there is **no other meeple** anywhere on the same road. The road is now occupied by you, but is still open and not completed. Therefore, no points are scored in this turn (**Step 3**) and it is the next player's turn in clockwise order. That player now draws a land tile and places it. Since there is already a meeple (your traveler) on the road leading to the right of the village, they can **not** place a meeple on that particular road. Instead, the player places their meeple as a knight in the city on the tile they just placed (more on cities later).



You place a meeple as a traveler on the tile you just placed. As there is no other meeple on that road, this is allowed.



The road to the right is already occupied. Blue decides to place a meeple in the city.

3. Score points

If a road was **closed at both ends** in **Step 1**, this road is **complete** and will now be **scored**. An end of a road is considered closed if it leads into a village, a city, a monastery or another part of the landscape that clearly closes it off visually. In our example, your road is closed at both ends and is now scored! It does not matter who placed the tile that completed the road. For **each tile** of your completed road you score **1 point**. As your road consists of 3 tiles, you score 3 points!

To keep track of your points, the scoreboard comes in handy. Move your score meeple forward 1 space for each point you score. In this example you move your score meeple 3 spaces forward. Whenever your score meeple reaches **space 0** again, take one of the **score tiles** and/or flip it to the corresponding side as a reminder.

After scoring any feature (the road in this case), all players **return** all meeple that occupied the scored feature **to their respective supplies**.



You return the meeple that just scored 3 points to your supply. The Blue meeple is not returned as it occupies another feature. Its city is still open and has not been scored yet.

Important! A road is also complete when it forms a loop that leads into itself.

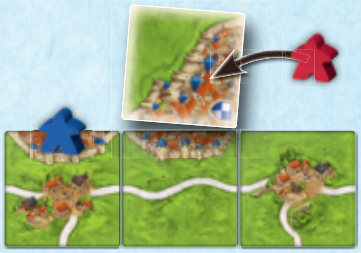
The Cities

1. Place a land tile

As always, you first draw a land tile and place it adjacent to matching land tiles in the play area. An open city can only be continued by another city segment.

2. Place a meeple

Next, check if the continued city is already occupied by another meeple. Since there is no meeple in that city, you may place one of your standard meeple as a **knight** on the **city** segment of the tile you just placed.

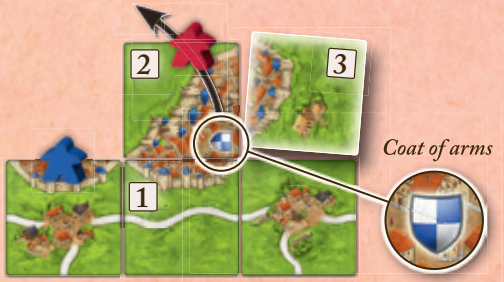


You have placed the tile so that it continues the open city. That city is not occupied, so you may place your meeple there.

3. Score points

Let's assume that you have placed the highlighted tile in your next round continuing your city. Your city feature is now complete. A city is considered complete, when it is **fully surrounded by city walls** and there are **no gaps** inside that city.

As you have a meeple in this city, you now score it. **Each tile** showing a segment of the city scores **2 points**. **Additionally, each coat of arms** in this city also scores **2 points**. As with any other scoring, you then return your scored meeple to your supply.



This city consists of 3 tiles and has 1 coat of arms. So you score 6 + 2 = 8 points! You then return your scored meeple to your supply.

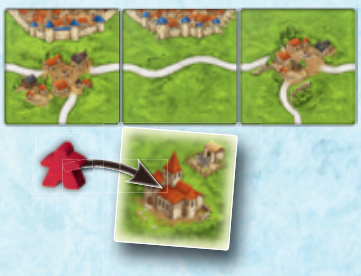
The Monasteries

1. Place a land tile

As always, you first draw a land tile and place it in the play area. Monasteries are always located in the centre of the tile. When placing it, you still need to make sure that the edges match all adjacent land tiles.

2. Place a meeple

If you have placed a tile with a **monastery**, you may place a standard meeple on it as a **monk**. You place the meeple from your supply onto the monastery.



The monastery is always located in the centre of a tile. You may place it here, as the field matches the field. Then you place a standard meeple on it.

3. Score points

A monastery is considered complete when it is **surrounded by 8 adjacent tiles**. This refers to the 8 tiles that are **directly** or **diagonally** adjacent to the monastery. Once your monastery is completed, you score **1 point** for each tile, including the monastery itself, for a total of **9 points**.



Finally! With this tile the monastery is completely surrounded. You score 9 points and return your meeple to your supply.

Now you know the most important rules and may start playing. In the following section, we will clarify details on special cases and the final scoring, so that you can look them up when the time comes.

Several meeple on a single feature

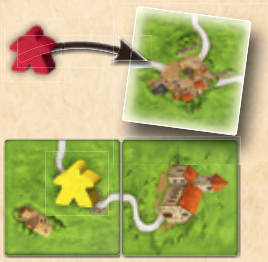
During the course of the game, it can happen that several meeple occupy the same feature (road, city, etc.) by retroactively connecting their individual features. You can find examples of this below.

Determining majorities

If meeple of several players are involved in the scoring of the same feature, you must first determine the **strength** of all players on the scored feature. **1 standard meeple** has a **strength of 1**. Add up the strengths of your meeple on the feature and compare it with the strength of the others. If your total strength on the feature is higher than that of the player with the second-highest total strength, you have the **majority**. In this case, **only you** score this feature.

If there is a tie for the majority, each tied player scores **the full number of points** for that feature.

After scoring, all players return their meeple from the scored feature to their supplies.



The tile you drew could continue the road on the bottom-left tile. Because there is already a meeple on that road, you would not be able to place a meeple on that road.
So instead, you place the tile such that the roads are not directly connected and place your meeple on the newly placed road.



In one of your next turns you draw this tile and place it next to the open road. There are now 2 meeple on one single connected road. As that road is complete, it is now scored. Yellow and you each score 4 points and return your meeple to your supplies.



You hope to get the majority in the Yellow player's city, so you place a tile with a city segment as shown and place one of your meeple onto it as a knight.
You may do this because the city segment you placed is not connected to another occupied city.



Let's assume that you drew a matching tile and placed it in such a way that all 3 cities now form one single city. As you have more meeple in the completed city than Yellow , only you score the 10 points for that city. You both return your meeple to your supplies.

GAME END & FINAL SCORING

The game ends when **all land tiles** from the face-down tile stacks have been placed and no player is able to place another tile in their turn. Before determining the winner of the game, you must resolve the **final scoring**.

Final Scoring

Now, all incomplete features still occupied by meeple are scored as follows (determine majorities as usual):

- Each incomplete road scores **1 point** per tile, just like during the game.
- Each incomplete city scores **1 point** per tile and per coat of arms, so only half the points.
- Each incomplete monastery scores **1 point** and **additionally 1 point** per tile that is directly or diagonally adjacent to it.
- Each field scores **3 points** for each complete city touching that field. A field itself is never considered complete even if it is fully enclosed by landscape features.
  This refers to the farmer scoring and is listed here for clarity. However, we suggest to ignore the rules for farmers during the first few games and only add them later whenever you feel ready. The farmers are explained on page 8.

Final Scoring - City
Green scores 8 points for this large, incomplete city (5 tiles and 3 coats of arms). Black does not score any points, because Green has the majority in the city (with 2 standard meeple).



Final Scoring - Monastery
Yellow scores 4 points for this incomplete monastery (3 surrounding land tiles and the monastery itself).

Final Scoring - City
Blue scores 3 points for this incomplete city (2 land tiles and 1 coat of arms).

Final Scoring - Road
You score 3 points for the incomplete road (consisting of 3 land tiles).

Once all final scoring has been resolved, the player with the most points wins this game of **Carcassonne**. Congratulations! (In the event of a tie, all tied players win).

Once you have played the base game a few times, we recommend adding the rules for the **farmers** (page 8).

Are you up for new challenges? Then take a look at the rules for the expansions **The River** and **The Abbot** on page 9. And from there you can work your way through the rulebook and discover and combine the many other expansions and mini-expansions. Have fun exploring the endless possibilities of the Big Box!

Quick Overview

1. Place a land tile

Draw **1 tile** and place it so that it matches the landscape. In the rare case that you **cannot** place a matching tile **anywhere**, return the tile to the box and draw a new one.

2. Place a meeple

You may place exactly **1 meeple** from your supply on a feature on the land tile you just placed.
This is only possible if that feature is **not** occupied by another meeple.

3. Score points

Scoring is resolved at the end of a turn if **1 or more features** have been **completed** in that turn.

- A **road** is complete, when it has no open ends. You score **1 point per tile** with a road segment.
- A **city** is complete when it is fully surrounded by a city wall and it has no gaps.
  You score **2 points per tile** with a city segment and **2 points per coat of arms**.
- A **monastery** is complete when 8 tiles are directly and diagonally adjacent to it.
  You score **9 points** for a complete monastery (1 point per surrounding tile and 1 point for the monastery itself).

If several players are involved in a scoring, only those with the majority score the points.
After scoring, return all involved meeple from the scored feature to their respective supplies.

The Farmers

The rules for farmers give your meeple a new ability. They are an optional part of the base game.

1. Place a land tile

As always, you draw a land tile and place it, continuing the landscape. The green landscapes are features called **fields**.

2. Place a meeple

You may place a meeple **lying down** on a **field** as a **farmer**. Unlike travelers, knights, and monks, which are all placed standing up, farmers are placed lying down on their field feature. This is a reminder that farmers and fields are scored only in the **final scoring**, not during the game the way other meeple are. As with other features, you may lay a farmer only on a field that does not already have another farmer on it. The fields are separated by cities, roads, the river (see mini-expansion **The River**), and other landscape features that visually separate fields. For instance, the example to the right shows 3 separate fields.



You place a tile that continues a large field stretching from your tile along the road all the way to a city where you have a knight. This field is not occupied. So you may place a meeple lying down on this field as a farmer.

3. Score points

Unlike other features, a field is **never** considered **complete**. Even if a field is fully enclosed by landscape features, farmers do **not** score points and are **not** returned to your supply **during the game**. Fields are scored **only** in the **final scoring**.

Final Scoring

At the end of the final scoring, you resolve the **farmer scoring**. If a field is occupied by several farmers, determine the majority for each field as usual. Whoever has the majority on a field scores **3 points** for **each complete city touching** that field. A single complete city can be scored by multiple fields.



This field occupied by red and blue is touching 3 complete cities A , B , and D. This field scores 3 x 3 = 9 points.
Since Red and Blue are tied for the majority, both players score 9 points. City C is not complete, and does not count towards this field's scoring.
Black and yellow both have farmers on this field .
Black has the majority on this field, and scores the full 4 x 3 = 12 points for the 4 complete cities touching this field.
Yellow has a farmer on the field in the top left corner, and scores 2 x 3 = 6 points for the 2 complete cities, A and B, touching that field.

Quick Overview

- Farmers are placed **lying down**.
- Farmers are not scored until **final scoring**.
- Each complete city touching a field scores **3 points**.
- As with other features, the player with the majority on a field scores the points for that field. If multiple players are tied for the majority, **all tied players** score the **full points**.